HR SCREENING CALL — FLUENT SPEAKING SCRIPT

Authentic, Confident & Natural Conversation Guide for Santhosh A

Product Designer & Design Engineer • 6+ Years Experience • designbysanthosh.com • +91 99412 92729

QUESTION 01

“Tell me about yourself / Walk me through your background.”

> **Strategy:** The 90-second pitch (Identity → Evidence → Impact → Current Goal). Sound conversational, not robotic.

“Sure! I am a **Product Designer with a Design Engineering background and 6+ years of experience** taking digital products from zero to one. What gives my profile a unique edge is my engineering degree (B.Tech in IT)—so while I lead end-to-end user research, interaction architecture, and scalable Figma design systems, I also have practical fluency in frontend code like React, HTML, CSS, and database structures.

Over the past 6 years, I have worked across enterprise ecommerce, B2B SaaS, and operational platforms. Most notably at **Parla Retail**, I led UX for our flagship *‘Show & Sell’* live video consultation suite and automated appointment scheduler for US enterprise client Nebraska Furniture Mart, where our sales team reported a **31% lift in booking completion and a 26% reduction in drop-offs**.

More recently, at my studio Commerce Agents, I designed and shipped complete systems like *Vidya’s Kitchen* (an automated food ordering PWA and kitchen ops dispatch board) and *We Two Pets*.

Right now, I am looking for my next high-impact role where I can partner closely with engineering squads and product managers to solve complex user workflows and build products people genuinely love.”

QUESTION 02

“What are your core strengths as a designer?”

> **Strategy:** Frame your answer around 3 pillars: Design-Engineering Bridge, Simplifying Complex Workflows, and Business Impact.

“I would summarize my core strengths into three distinct pillars:

- **1. Zero Design-to-Dev Friction:** Because of my IT background, I design with technical feasibility built-in. When I create a component or design token in Figma, I already understand the DOM structure, API requirements, and component states, saving engineering squads dozens of revision cycles.
- **2. Simplifying Complex Data & Workflows:** I thrive in dense, multi-step environments—whether it is real-time IoT battery telemetry for iRasus, rural kiosk diagnostics for IndiaOne ATM, or calendar booking sync across timezones at Parla. I excel at turning chaotic workflows into calm, intuitive operator interfaces.
- **3. Business-Outcome Driven:** I do not design purely for aesthetics. Every flow I craft is tied to clear conversion metrics, reduced cognitive load, and measurable business outcomes.”

QUESTION 03

“Why did you leave your previous company / Why are you looking for a change?”

> **Strategy:** Always speak positively about past roles. Frame the move as an intentional evolution toward scaling long-term product impact.

“At Parla Retail, I had a fantastic journey collaborating directly with UK leadership and US enterprise clients. We took the ‘Show & Sell’ suite from early concepts to a mature, high-performing product that delivered proven revenue and booking lifts.

After that milestone, I spent time co-founding Commerce Agents to sharpen my 0-to-1 product muscle—shipping end-to-end applications from discovery through code. Having strengthened both my design architecture and product leadership, I am now deliberately seeking to bring that comprehensive experience back into an established product team where I can take long-term ownership of a core product surface and collaborate with a global team.”

QUESTION 04

“What is your current CTC and salary expectation?”

> **Strategy:** State your previous baseline transparently, state your target range with market justification, and emphasize mutual alignment.

“At Parla Retail, my fixed base compensation was **₹9 LPA**.

For my next role—given my 6+ years of full-stack product design experience, design engineering capabilities, and current Chennai/hybrid market benchmarks—I am targeting an annual CTC between **₹14 LPA and ₹16 LPA** (with an ideal target around ₹15 LPA).

That said, I am genuinely excited about what your team is building, and if there is a strong mutual fit, I am completely open to discussing a compensation structure that aligns with your company’s standard salary bands.”

QUESTION 05

“How do you handle disagreements with developers or product managers?”

> **Strategy:** Show that you collaborate with empathy and logic rather than emotional attachment to your designs.

“I view disagreements as opportunities to align on goals rather than personal debates. Product managers care deeply about business roadmaps and deadlines; developers care about architectural complexity and performance; designers care about user clarity.

When a disagreement arises, I follow two principles:

- **Let User Evidence Decide:** If there is debate over a flow, I set up a rapid unmoderated test on Maze or check past user analytics to see how users actually behave.
- **Collaborative Technical Trade-offs:** Because I understand frontend code, I sit down with the developers and ask: *‘What part of this design is causing the highest engineering overhead?’* Often, we can alter 10% of the UI pattern to eliminate 80% of the engineering complexity while keeping the user experience completely intact.”

QUESTION 06

“What is your notice period and location preference?”

> **Strategy:** Immediate availability is a superpower for HRs. State it proudly.

“I am currently working independently through my product studio, which means I have **zero notice period and immediate availability**—I can join your team right away.

In terms of location, I am permanently based in Chennai. I am fully comfortable with on-site, hybrid, or remote working models.”

QUESTION 07

“Do you have any questions for us?”

> **Strategy:** Never say “No, you covered everything.” Asking thoughtful, high-level questions proves your seniority and interest in their business.

“Yes, I have three quick questions:

- **1. On Problem Discovery:** How does the design team currently collaborate with Product and Engineering? Are designers involved early during discovery and problem framing?
- **2. On Roadmaps:** What is the single biggest UX or product challenge the team is working to solve over the next two quarters?
- **3. On Success:** For someone stepping into this role, what would success look like in the first 90 days?”